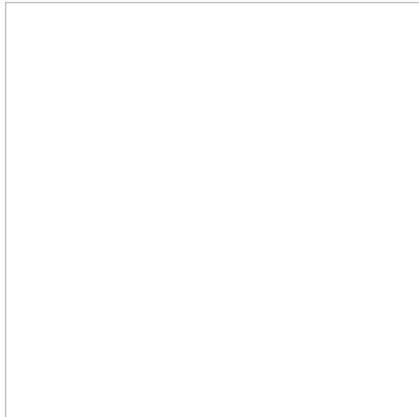


Spring Semester, 2022, Faculty of Architecture, CEPT University

Course: **S2022_AR2041: Vernacular Resurgence**
Course Tutor/s: **Hamid Raj**
Mode: **Online**
Image of Final Output:



(Other images click here) 

Link to CEPT Portfolio :
(studio work from past semesters)

Long Description :

Ahmedabad is 610 years old, famed for its architecture and has been recently declared as a 'World Heritage City' by UNESCO. Over the past century, and especially the last five decades the city has witnessed a major decline and massive loss to its priceless heritage. The prototypical planning of its pol and individual pol houses date back centuries and they still stand the test of time making them living monuments. The studio proposes to design in this context which is laden with a rich history. The focus and challenges would be to personalize and customize spaces for individual needs and aspirations of a family, by designing a residence at an actual site in the walled city. Before working on the design, understanding and sensitizing ourselves to this context within which we propose to build is extremely crucial. In order to acclimatize with this context, a thorough study of the planning and organization of the pols and the pol houses shall be conducted. To be able to truly appreciate the vernacular designs, one has to also study the use of materials, construction techniques and structural systems. These designs were made for a people of a bygone era and one needs to understand the impact of the dramatic shift in lifestyle of the current day user living in these homes in order to cater to their needs and aspirations. The design process involves addressing specific client requirements, responding to immediate site conditions; while understanding and appropriately extrapolating from the wisdom of the vernacular keeping in mind its relevance in today's time. At the end of the semester, the students shall make a design proposal complete with structure, spatial planning and the furniture layout.

Course Expense :
(INR -extra expenditure a student would incur during the semester)

INR Rs. 10000/- (undefinedRupees)

Course Prerequisite:

Problem Statement:

Learning Outcomes :

After completing the Studio, the student will be able to :

- Explore form and space through plans, sections, sketches, physical models and software modelling.
- Recognize and relate stakeholders and functions in order to come up with suitable space adjacency diagrams.
- Understand user requirements, respond to the site context and determine a set of design criteria.
- Plan, organize and design spaces while personalizing and customizing them for a given set of users.
- Analyze, compare, assess and choose a suitable structural system. Prepare a set of presentation drawings. Build a rationale, communicate and convey ideas and strategy.

Weekly Plan &
Assessment:

Weeks	Exercise Description	Assessment	
		%	Criteria
Week 1	Class 1: Site Visit - Introduction to the studio, with a briefing about the site and a walk through the various pols. Class 2: Site visit - Familiarize with the old city of Ahmedabad via documentation and mapping. Class 3: Site visit – A visit to Deewanji Ni Haveli to understand the planning and organization of a traditional Pol house.	0	1. Attendance 2. Participation and inputs.
Week 2	Class 1: Site visit – Deewanji Ni Haveli – Study in detail the use of materials, structural system and construction methods. Class 2 and 3: Study in detail the various building elements of Diwanji Ni Haveli and prepare sketches and drawings of the same.	0	1. Attendance 2. Participation and inputs.
Week 3	Class 1: Document the actual site and its immediate surroundings, and prepare a set of drawings. Class 2 and 3 : Make a physical and a digital site model (group work) and analyse the site (individual work).	0	1. Attendance 2. Participation and inputs 3. Quality of Presentation
Week 4	Class 1: Detail out the family profile for whom the residence shall be designed, and prepare a list of spatial requirements. Class 2 and 3 : Work out adjacency diagrams and prepare a statement of intent.	0	1. Participation and inputs. 2. Clarity of ideas and representation
Week 5	Class 1,2 and 3 : Carry out anthropometric studies for individual activities at various scales.	0	1. Participation and inputs. 2. Accuracy and quality of drawings
Week 6	Class 1,2 and 3 : Work on conceptual ideas and prepare design options based on the adjacency diagrams and the statement of intent.	0	1. Clarity of ideas. 2. Quality of Representation
Week 7	Class 1,2 and 3 : Analyse the merits and demerits in order to choose from the various design options. Commit to a design option and make volumetric explorations via mediums of sketches, drawings and models.	0	1. Clarity of ideas. 2. Quality of Representation
Week 8	Class 1,2 and 3 : Continue work on the design and incorporate the furniture layout.	0	1. Clarity of ideas. 2. Quality of Representation
Week 9	Class 1 and 2 : Prepare a set of preliminary drawings and models for the mid-semester review. Class 3: Mid-Term Review	30	1. Overall process 2. Clarity of ideas 3. Attendance 4. Quality of presentation drawings 5. Explorations with Models 6. Rationale and Communication
Week 10	Class 1,2 and 3 : Refine design based on the feedback received.	0	1. Process
Week 11	Class 1,2 and 3 : Analyze, compare and evaluate various structural systems.	0	1. Process 2. Rationale
Week 12	Class 1,2 and 3 : Incorporate materials and choose a suitable structural system.	0	1. Process 2. Rationale
Week 13	Class 1,2 and 3 : Select and detail out any one space from the proposed design.	0	1. Process 2. Quality of drawings
Week 14	Class 1,2 and 3 : Continue working and finalize a set of drawings indicating material, structure and furniture.	0	1. Process 2. Quality of drawings
Week 15	Class 1,2 and 3 : Start work on making a final drawing set and a digital/physical model.	0	-
Week 16	Class 1 and 2 : Continue and complete the presentation Class 3 : Critical review/ Final jury	40	1. Overall process 2. Clarity of ideas 3. Attendance 4. Quality of presentation drawings 5. Explorations with Models 6. Rationale and Communication

References :

1. Architecture - Form, Space and order. D.K Francis Ching

Tutor Profile:

Hamid Shueb Raj is an alumnus of SID, CEPT '92 and attended the co-op program in Architecture at Washington University in St. Louis '99. He has worked with Snehal Nagarsheth (Ahmedabad), OWH architects (St. Louis), Bijoy Jain & Associates (Alibaug-Mumbai) and Modfurn (Chennai). He has worked on architectural, interior design and furniture design projects and is teaching at CEPT since 2012.



Note : This course outline is subject to change.